

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

GUIDELINE MANUAL

VOLUME 6

Policy: 600.08 Trench Rescue Operations

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D. Remove dirt from the collapsed zone while remaining in the safe zone.

E. Secure all utilities, pipe, or other obstructions in the trench.

II. VICTIM REMOVAL / INCIDENTS **WITHOUT** COLLAPSE

A. Create a safe zone around the victim.

B. Remove objects trapping the victim such as pipes, lumber, machinery, etc.

C. Assess victim's condition.

D. Properly package the patient and remove from the trench.

III. VICTIM REMOVAL / INCIDENTS **WITH** COLLAPSE

A. Begin dirt removal while operating from a safe zone.

B. Continue extending safe zone into collapse zone.

C. Create a safe zone around the victim.

D. Uncover victim to below the diaphragm utilizing small shovels, buckets, or by hand, and assess the victim's condition.

E. Completely uncover the victim, properly package the patient, and remove from the trench.

IV. TREATMENT

A. Conduct a primary survey upon reaching the victim.

B. Initiate C-spine precautions as soon as possible.

C. Conduct a secondary survey and correct any life-threatening conditions.

D. Consider removing the victim from danger prior to providing definitive care.

E. Provide ALS level treatment and transportation to a hospital as indicated.

Phase IV Termination

A. Ensure personnel accountability.

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- B. Remove tools, equipment, and the trench shoring system (last-in / first-out) from the trench. In cases of a fatality, consider leaving everything in place until the investigative process has been completed.
- C Consider a Post Incident Critique (may be more appropriate later).
- D. Return to service after turning the scene over to the responsible party and ensuring the scene is secure.

ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS

I. COMMAND STRUCTURE

- A. The first arriving unit shall assume Command of the incident. This unit shall remain in Command until Command is transferred to improve the quality of the Command organization. A Command Team shall be assembled to include, at a minimum, a Chief Officer, and a Technical Advisor.
- B. Considerations for the Technical Advisor include:
 - One of the Regional Special Operations qualified Safety Officers.
 - Any experienced TRT Company Officer assigned to the incident.

The first arriving TRT unit that is staffed with a TRT Company Officer shall be assigned Rescue Sector. Rescue teams, Lobby, Ventilation, Air Monitoring, Shoring, Cut teams, and any other such functional team operating in the hazard zone shall be under the direction of Rescue Sector. Rescue Sector will communicate directly with TRT units assigned to these functions within Rescue Sector and shall keep Command informed during all phases of the rescue operation.

- C. Considerations for Safety Officer include:
 - One of the Regional Special Operations qualified Safety Officers.
 - Any experienced TRT Company Officer assigned to the incident.

II. OTHER CONSIDERATIONS

- A. Consider the effects of inclement weather on the hazard profile, the victim(s), and the rescuers.

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- B. Maintain awareness of the time of day and ensure sufficient lighting is available on the scene if operations extend into the night.
- C. Trench incidents attract the news media; consider assigning a P.I.O.
- D. Request OSHA response if there has been a serious injury or death.